

Almanac 47

Celestial navigation on the SwissMicros C47 — user manual

Almanac 47 puts an almanac page on the C47: GHA, declination, Hc and Zn of the Sun, the Moon, the planets and the navigation stars for your DR and time, sunrise, sunset, twilight and the Moon's phase, with horizon charts of the sky. Everything is computed on the calculator (VSOP87, Meeus, IAU precession and nutation); optional Chebyshev tables fitted to JPL make it faster for a chosen period.

It supports, and does not replace, the Nautical Almanac. Every screen says so.

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Part 1 — using NAV

1. What to load

File	What it is
NAVFULL	the program NAV with all the views and the almanac tables support (TBL)
NAVTEXT	text only (no drawing): the almanac page in the registers; NAV runs INIT the first time; reads TBL too
NAVINIT_FULL	INIT: builds the series matrices, valid 2000–2050 (about 6 000 numbers)
NAVINIT_FAST	INIT: fitted series, valid 2026–2030: smaller and faster
TBL_1, TBL_5	optional almanac tables (JPL) for 1 or 5 years from 1 Oct 2026; XEQ TBL once, then delete it. Big: meant for Free42 / Plus42 on a PC or phone; on the C47 only a short table fits
NAVLITTLE	build/dm42/: for the old DM42 with the C47 firmware (64 KiB): the ALMANAC screen, Sun and 58 stars only, with NAVINIT_LITTLE (2000–2050)

2. First start

- Convert each text file with **rejig** (rejig FILE.txt -o FILE.p47) and load it on the C47.
- The file name is the version: on the calculator the programs are always NAV and INIT. Other builds (NAVFULL_NOTBL, NAVALL, NAVCOMP) are in build/dev/.
- Load one NAV file and one NAVINIT file. **XEQ "INIT"** once: it builds the matrices and shows MATRICES READY. Then delete INIT (GTO "INIT", CLP): the matrices stay.
- Optional: load TBL, XEQ "TBL" once, delete it. The screens then show T (tables) instead of S (series).
- NAV asks DATE in the calculator's date format (CLK menu: YYYY-MM-DD, DD.MM.YYYY or MM/DD/YYYY) and reads it with the C47's own date functions; the message line shows which.

3. Starting NAV

XEQ "NAV" asks four numbers, once, with INPUT (R/S keeps the value shown). The message line shows the formats: DATE YYYY.MMDD UT HH.MMSS LAT DD.MMm LON DDD.MMm S W - (DATE DD.MMYYYY or DATE MM.DDYYYY when the CLK date format is D.MY or M.DY).

Input	Meaning	Example
DATE	UT date in the CLK date format: YYYY.MMDD, DD.MMYYYY or MM.DDYYYY	2026.0926
UTC	UT, HH.MMSS (UT1; add DUT1 to UTC for full accuracy)	14.57
LAT	latitude DD.MMm, south negative	25.20 = 25° 20' N
LON	longitude DDD.MMm, west negative	55.12 = 55° 12' E

After LON the sky is computed (the Sun, the Moon, the planets, the stars that can be above the horizon, the sun times) and kept in the matrix ALMC. Then the menu appears, and every view only draws. While the calculator works, a box in the middle of the screen says SINKING....ABOUT (after LON, after a menu number, + and the arrows) until the new screen is drawn.

ALMANAC 47		VALID 2000-2050	
26-09-2026 14:57 UT		DR N 25 20.0 E 55 12.0	
1 ALMANAC	6 SPLIT		
2 CHART	7 BODY		
3 TEXT	SINKING....ABOUT		
4 SKY	9 ALLSKY		
5 SMALL	0 END		
KEY A NUMBER		+ MENU	UP DOWN 1 HOUR
DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC			

4. The menu

ALMANAC 47		VALID 2026-2030	
28-09-2026	18:00 UT	DR N 25	12.0 E 55 18.0
1 ALMANAC		6 ANIM	
2 CHART		7 ALLSKY	
3 TEXT		8 INFO	
4 SKY		0 END	
5 SPLIT			
KEY A NUMBER	+ MENU	UP DOWN 1 HOUR	
DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC			

Title ALMANAC 47, the period the matrices are valid for, the date, UT and DR in use.

Key	On the menu	On a view
1 – 8	the item is highlighted and its view is drawn	—
9	SNAP (a screenshot)	SNAP (a screenshot)
+	—	back to the menu
▲ / ▼	one hour later / earlier (the title shows the new time)	the same view one hour later / earlier
0	end of NAV: clears the screen and the stack	—
other keys	ignored	ignored (R/S or EXIT stop the program)

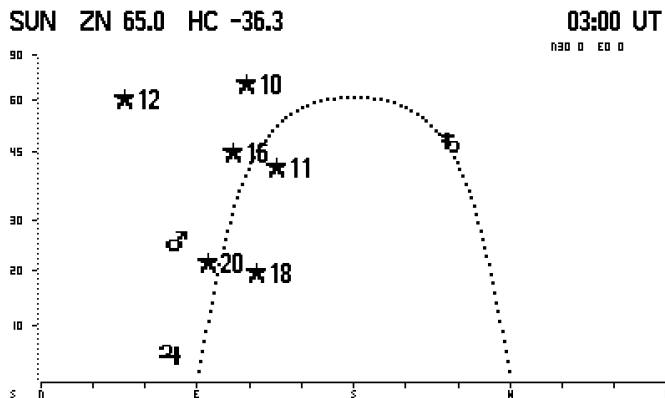
The hours added with the arrows stay for the other views. New date or position: XEQ "NAV" again.

5. The views

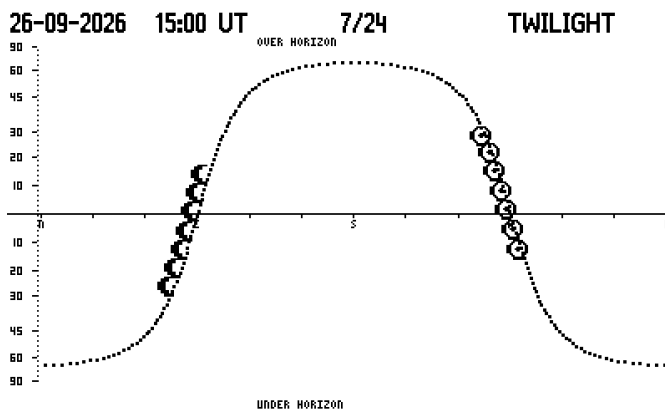
All examples: 26 Sep 2026 14:57 UT, 25° 20' N 055° 12' E, unless stated.

23-09-2026 23:30 UT		DR N 10 00.0 W 75 30.0		S					
BODY		GHA		DEC		HC		ZN	
☉	ARIES	355	19.5						
	SUN	174	26.9	S	0 22.8	-8 52.7			271.2
☾	MOON	25	09.3	S	12 19.9	35 13.9			113.0
♀	VENUS	142	57.4	S	19 47.4	17 14.7			245.5
★ 37	ARCTURUS	141	06.4	N	19 02.7	26 10.6			286.4
★ 49	VEGA	75	51.7	N	38 48.8	61 11.1			359.4
★ 51	ALTAIR	57	17.9	N	8 56.5	72 01.1			091.8
★ 42	ANTARES	107	33.7	S	26 29.5	42 01.7			219.8
★ 56	FOMALHAUT	10	32.1	S	29 28.7	16 06.1			124.8
★ 53	DENEb	44	44.1	N	45 22.8	45 53.3			031.1
NAUT TWI 10:06 23:43		MOON 92% WAXING							
RISE/SET 10:51 22:57		AGE 12.8 DAYS							
MER PASS 16:54 SD 15.9		HP 56.0 SD 15.3							

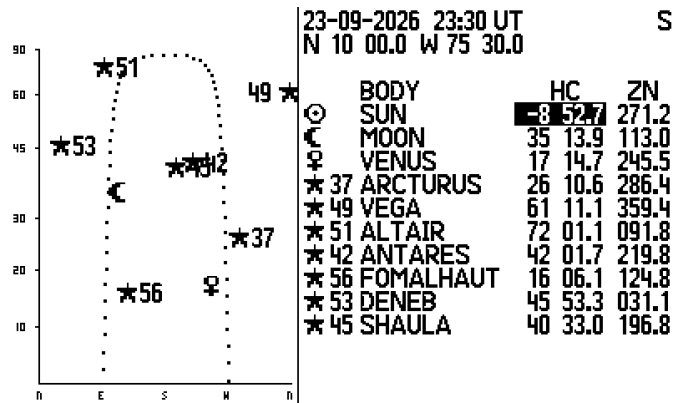
1 ALMANAC (ALMF): GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn of 10 bodies — the Sun, the Moon and planets above the horizon, the brightest stars higher than 10°; twilight, rise/set, meridian passage, Moon phase, HP, SD. 23 Sep 2026 23:30 UT, 10° N 075° 30' W.



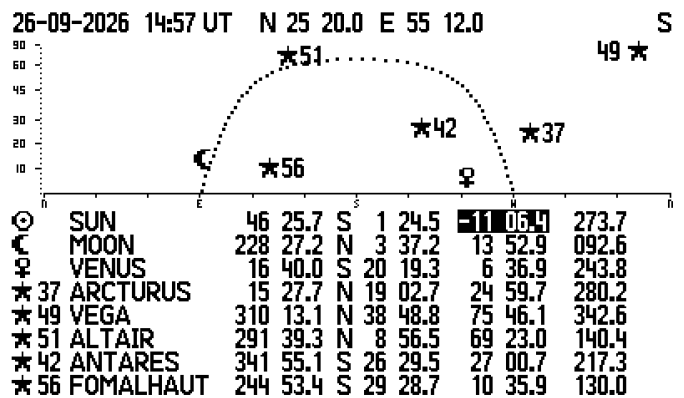
4 SKY (HORZ): full-screen chart; the top line names each body in turn (3 s each), UT at the top right, DR under it. 23 Sep 2026 03:00 UT, 30° N 0° E.



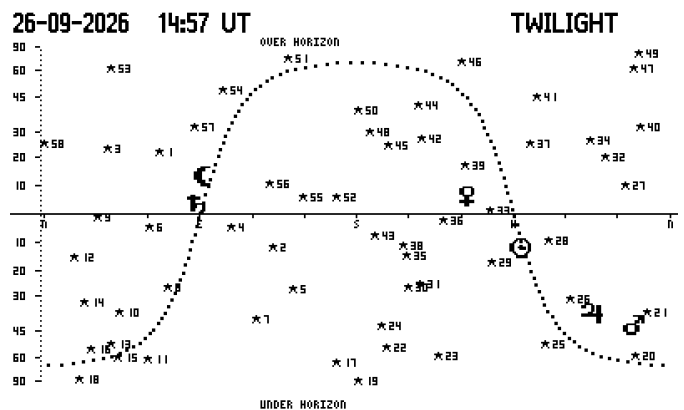
6 ANIM (HANIM): the Sun and the Moon moving over 12 hours (24 frames, 1 s each).



2 CHART (HALMV): the sky on the left (Hc up, Zn across, the celestial equator dotted), the Hc/Zn table on the right (no ARIES row, no Moon line). Same time and place.



5 SPLIT (HALMH): the chart on top, the bodies below down to the bottom of the screen (8 rows). 26 Sep 2026 14:57 UT, 25° 20' N 055° 12' E.



7 ALLSKY: the whole sky, over the horizon above, under the horizon below: every star, the Sun, the Moon and the planets; DAY / TWILIGHT / NIGHT.

ALMANAC 47 - INFO

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COPYRIGHT 2026 VICTOR VALDES
FREE SOFTWARE: GNU GPL V3 OR LATER

NO WARRANTY - IT MAY HAVE BUGS AND
ALWAYS CROSS-CHECK THE VALUES
WITH THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

THE ANTS ARE WAITING FOR A FLAG
+ MENU

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

8 INFO: the repository (github.com/valdesvj/almanac47), the licence (GNU GPL v3 or later), no warranty, and the rule: always cross-check the values with the Nautical Almanac. The warning line (DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC) is on the menu and on INFO only.

9 SNAP, on the menu and on every view: a screenshot of the screen (SNAP), then the same screen again.

3 TEXT (ALMR): the same page as text, one line per register (R50 ..., lines 1-26 also in the stack and the lettered registers). NAV ends and opens the register browser (REGS). XEQ "NAV" for the menu again.

Below the horizon: a body with a negative Hc (in practice the Sun) has its Hc shown white on black, as the Sun in the ALMANAC and CHART examples above.

6. Speed and memory

- The sky is computed once for a time and place (matrix ALMC, 73×4 : GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn of the Sun, the Moon, planets 1-4 and stars 1-58). Going from view to view only draws. An arrow (a new hour) computes again.
- The celestial equator of the charts depends only on the position: it is kept in ALMQ (300×3) and redrawn from there.
- The fonts read each column pattern from stack register D: NAV uses the 8-level stack while it runs and puts your stack size back when you leave with 0 or TEXT.
- The C47 sends a new screen to the display only at a PAUSE, a key press or the end of the program. NAV makes a PAUSE 0 after each drawing (no wait), so every screen appears complete, at once, and the SINKING box stays until the next screen is ready. (Holding a key while a view draws makes the C47 show the drawing step by step.)
- Free42 on the DM42 / DM42n (build/free42) shows every drawing step at once, so the screens build up in front of you. The Free42 NAVFULL and NAVLITTLE switch this off with the DM42 variable RefLCD (0 = no update, -1 = update once, 7 = normal) and so behave like the C47.
- With the tables (TBL) the Sun, the Moon and the planets come from the tables inside their period and the computation is about twice as fast.
- Something lives in NAV at the step after LBL 48. It is 0. Try 20 and press + or an arrow ...

7. Program map

In the NAV files every program label except NAV is renamed N01, N02 ... (so the names do not clash with your own programs). This is the map of the navigation routines in NAVFULL; the font routines (PTXS, PTXT and their number entries, N52–N62) are left out. The numbers are fixed (tools/labels/NAVFULL.map): a new routine gets the next free number, so the labels stay the same from one version to the next.

NAVFULL_NOTBL has the same labels without N50 (TGET). NAVTXT and NAVLITTLE have their own numbering: see their _LABELS.txt files.

Label	Name	What it does
NAV	NAV	graphic menu (KEY?): asks DATE UTC LAT LON, key 1-7 a view, 8 INFO, 9 SNAP, 0 ends (the only named program; INFO page inside)
N01	ALMF	view 1 ALMANAC: GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn table of Sun, Moon, planets, stars; twilight, rise/set, Moon
N02	HALMV	view 2 CHART: horizon chart left, Hc/Zn of 10 bodies right (no ARIES, no Moon line)
N03	ALMR	view 3 TEXT: the almanac page as text in R50-R76 (and the stack and lettered registers); NAV ends in REGS
N04	HORZ	view 4 SKY: horizon chart, info line per body every 3 s (+ back to the menu, arrows one hour)
N06	HALMH	view 5 SPLIT: horizon chart on top, the bodies below (8 rows)
N07	SDM	text: degrees and minutes "ddd°mm.m" as a string
N08	SNS	text: latitude with N / S
N09	SEW	text: longitude with E / W
N10	SZN	text: azimuth "ddd.d°"
N11	SHM	text: time "hh:mm" (--:-- when no event)
N12	SF1	text: number with one decimal
N13	SINT	text: whole number
N14	SDAT	text: date "dd-mm-yyyy" from a Julian Date
N15	SUNA	Sun: VSOP87 series (matrices VL VB VR), nutation, aberration -> GHA, Dec, GHA Aries
N16	SUNG	Sun GHA/Dec for the sunrise iterations (tables if loaded, else SUNF)
N17	SUNF	Sun, low-precision formula (0.01 deg) for sunrise/twilight
N18	SER	sum of one series matrix with the matrix functions (COS, DOT)
N19	SERT	the time vectors SV1 SV2 used by SER
N20	NUT	nutation in longitude and obliquity (matrix NU)
N21	STAR	star: SUNA, then STR2
N22	STR2	star GHA/Dec: catalogue ST, precession, aberration, nutation (after SUNA)
N23	SQK	star, quick sin(Hc) from the catalogue (to skip stars below the horizon)
N24	MOON	Moon: SUNA, then MOO2
N25	MOO2	Moon GHA, Dec, HP, SD: Meeus series (matrices ML MB MCL MCB) after SUNA
N26	MOOQ	Moon, quick low-precision formula (BODY list, ANIM)
N27	PLAN	planet: SUNA, then PLN2
N28	PLN2	planet GHA/Dec/SHA/HP: VSOP87 series with light-time, after SUNA
N29	PLN3	planet for the screens: quick position first, full series only if it can be above the horizon
N30	PLNQ	planet, quick position from mean elements (BODY list)
N31	CHZ	sight reduction with all inputs: Dec, GHA, lat, lon -> Hc, Zn
N32	HCZ	sight reduction: Y = Dec, X = GHA -> Hc (R96), Zn (R97), sin Hc ("SHC")
N33	HCZ0	sight reduction for Dec 0 (equator points)
N34	HCZQ	celestial equator: start of the dot-by-dot rotation
N35	HCZR	celestial equator: next point by rotation (no trig)
N36	HCZI	keeps sin/cos of the latitude for HCZ
N37	DHA	inverse: from Hc and Zn back to Dec and GHA (star identification)
N38	RISE	sunrise time UT (SUNRISE program)
N39	SET	sunset time UT

Label	Name	What it does
N40	NTWA	nautical twilight, morning, UT
N41	NTWP	nautical twilight, evening, UT
N42	CTWA	civil twilight, morning, UT
N43	CTWP	civil twilight, evening, UT
N44	TRAN	meridian passage of the Sun, UT
N45	PHAS	Moon phase: SUNA, then PHA2
N46	PHA2	Moon phase after SUNA: illumination % and age in days
N47	SBRT	star number by brightness rank (1st brightest ... 58th)
N48	SNMU	star name from its number
N49	TGET	almanac tables (TBL): Chebyshev lookup (not in NAVFULL_NOTBL)
N61	HANIM	view 6 ANIM: the Sun and the Moon moving on the whole-sky chart (24 frames)
N62	ALLSKY	view 7 ALLSKY: whole sky, over the horizon above, under the horizon below
N63	WPLS	every view holds its screen here (KEY?): + back to the menu, up / down arrow one hour later / earlier
N64	CSUN	Sun from the cache (matrix ALMC); computes the whole sky (CALC) only for a new time or place
N65	CMOO	Moon from the cache
N66	CPLN	planet from the cache
N67	CSTR	star R82 from the cache
N68	CSQK	star from the cache: over the horizon test (computes the star the first time: SQK, STR2, HCZ)
N69	CHCZ	Hc Zn from the cache for the body just read (else the real HCZ)
N70	CPHA	Moon phase from the cache
N71	CNTA	nautical twilight am from the cache (the five sun times: computed once per date and place)
N72	CRIS	sunrise from the cache
N73	CTRN	meridian passage from the cache
N74	CSET	sunset from the cache
N75	CNTP	nautical twilight pm from the cache
N76	CALC	computes Sun, Moon, planets (GHA Dec Hc Zn) into matrix ALMC; stars marked to compute when asked
N77	CEQQ	celestial equator of the charts: start (replay from matrix ALMQ, or compute and record)
N78	CEQR	celestial equator of the charts: next dot (from ALMQ, or HCZR and record)

Part 2 — the programs one by one

How each program works, with worked results

These programs give the data needed for sight reduction (GHA, SHA, declination, Hc, Zn) and for planning (sunrise, sunset, twilight, Moon phase, sky picture). They support, and do not replace, the Nautical Almanac. All results are apparent geocentric positions, as in the almanac. The time argument is UT (UT1): for a sight timed in UTC, add DUT1 (under 0.9 s).

Overview

Program	What it gives	Input	Output	Needs
SUNA	Sun and Aries	X = JD	X GHA [☉] , Y Dec [☉] , Z GHA [♈]	matrices from MATA
MATA	builds Earth-orbit and nutation matrices	—	VL, VB, VR, NU	run once
STAR	57 navigation stars + Polaris	Y = JD, X = star no.	X GHA, Y Dec, Z SHA	SUNA, matrix ST
MATST	builds star catalogue matrix	—	ST	run once
SNAM	star name	X = star no.	name on screen	—
SUNRISE	rise, set, twilight, meridian passage	Z = JD 0h, Y = lat, X = lon	X = UT hours	SUNA
PHAS	Moon phase	X = JD	X % illuminated, Y age (days)	SUNA
HORZ	picture of the sky on the horizon	Z = JD, Y = lat, X = lon	screen drawing	SUNA, STAR
ALM	Sun, Aries, Moon, planets from tables	X = t (hours in block)	X GHA, Y Dec (HP)	coefficients from the tables
TBL	almanac tables for a period (JPL), sets flag 10	—	matrices TSU...TAR	run once
TGET	Sun, Aries, Moon, planets from the tables	Y = JD, X = body 0-6	X GHA, Y Dec (Z HP, T SD)	TBL
CHZ	Hc/Zn and the inverse	T lat, Z lon, Y Dec, X GHA	X Hc, Y Zn	—
SUNSD	Sun semi-diameter	X = JD	X = SD (')	SUNA
HALMV	sight-planning screen: chart + data	Z = JD, Y = lat, X = lon	screen	see HALMV section
ALMF	full-page almanac screen	Z = JD, Y = lat, X = lon	screen	see ALMF section
PTXS / PTXT	pixel text (big / small font)	Z = y, Y = x, X = text	drawing	—

Conventions

- **Julian Date (JD):** use the C47 date function (Date→J) and add UT/24. It must be a plain number: for example 23 Sep 2026 12:00 UT = **2461307**, and 0h UT that day = 2461306.5.
- **Signs:** latitude N +, S −; longitude E +, W −; declination negative = South.
- **Angles** come out in decimal degrees. Use →HMS or the d.mmm display to read degrees and minutes.
- **Setup order:** the NAV files do it all: load NAVFULL and NAVINIT_FULL (or NAVINIT_FAST), XEQ INIT once, delete INIT. The single programs of part 2 can still be loaded one by one (programs/ folder) for other uses.

SUNA — Sun and Aries

Computes the Sun's GHA and declination and the GHA of Aries for any instant, with no tables. It is also the engine used by STAR, SUNRISE, PHAS and HORZ.

How it works

- Time: T and τ (Julian centuries and millennia of TT since J2000; $TT = UT + 69.2$ s).
- Earth's heliocentric longitude L, latitude B and distance R from the VSOP87D series stored in VL, VB, VR (56 + 3 + 7 terms). The loops count rows with DSE 55.
- $Sun = L + 180^\circ$, $\beta = -B$; FK5 correction.
- Nutation $\Delta\psi$, $\Delta\epsilon$ from the 10 largest IAU 1980 terms (matrix NU). The Moon arguments D, M, M', F are kept in R60-R63 for PHAS.
- Apparent longitude $\lambda = Sun + \Delta\psi - 20.4898''/R$ (aberration). Obliquity $\epsilon = 84381.448'' - 46.815'' \cdot T + \Delta\epsilon$.
- $Dec = \arcsin(\sin \beta \cos \epsilon + \cos \beta \sin \epsilon \sin \lambda)$; RA from $\rightarrow POL$.
- $GHA^\gamma = GMST + \Delta\psi \cdot \cos \epsilon$; $GHA^\odot = GHA^\gamma - RA \pmod{360}$.

Inputs and outputs

Input	X = JD (UT1)
Output	X = $GHA^\odot$, Y = $Dec^\odot$, Z = GHA^γ (degrees). Also R73 = Sun distance R (au): $SD^\odot = 15.99' \div R73$.
Registers	R50-R55, R60-R67, R70-R81

Example with results

23 Sep 2026, 12:00:00 UT: key **2461307 XEQ SUNA**

	Result	Deg / min	Almanac page
X $GHA^\odot$	1.9069849	1° 54.4'	1° 54.4'
Y $Dec^\odot$	-0.1931700	S 0° 11.6'	S 0° 11.6'
Z GHA^γ	182.3525029	182° 21.2'	182° 21.2'
R73 $\rightarrow SD^\odot$	1.003445 au	15.94'	15.94'

Notes

- Accuracy vs JPL/IAU reference 2000–2050: $GHA \leq 0.016'$, $Dec \leq 0.007'$, $GHA^\gamma \leq 0.003'$. Verified on the C47.
- Coefficients never need updating. ΔT (69.2 s, line 4) affects the Sun by only 0.0007' per second.

MATA and MATST — setup programs

They contain no calculation. Each creates matrices and fills them with coefficients, so you don't have to type about 590 numbers by hand. Run each once; afterwards the programs can be deleted.

Program	Creates	Contents
MATA	VL 56×4, VB 3×4, VR 7×4	VSOP87D Earth series rows: k, A, B, C (term = $A \cdot \cos(B + C \cdot \tau) \cdot \tau^k$)
MATA	NU 10×9	IAU 1980 nutation: multipliers of D, M, M', F, Ω and coefficients S, S', C, C'
MATST	ST 58×4	Star J2000 RA, Dec (deg) and proper motions (mas/yr), stars 1–57 in almanac order, 58 = Polaris

Memory kept afterwards: about 5.7 KB (VL, VB, VR, NU) + 3.7 KB (ST).

STAR — navigation stars

Gives GHA, SHA and declination of any of the 57 almanac navigation stars or Polaris (58).

How it works

- Runs SUNA for the instant (nutation, obliquity, Sun longitude, GHA^γ). Entry STR2 skips this when SUNA has already run (used by HORZ).
- Reads the star's J2000 position and proper motion from ST and applies proper motion.
- Precession J2000 $\rightarrow$ date with the IAU 2006 angles ζ , z , θ .
- Converts to ecliptic coordinates and adds nutation $\Delta\psi$ and annual aberration there (accurate even for Polaris), then back with the true obliquity.
- $SHA = 360^\circ - RA$; $GHA = GHA^\gamma + SHA$.

Inputs and outputs

Input	Y = JD (UT1), X = star number 1-58
Output	X = GHA, Y = Dec, Z = SHA
Registers	R56-R59, R68-R69, R82-R89 (plus SUNA's)

Example with results

23 Sep 2026, 12:00 UT: key **2461307 ENTER 18 XEQ STAR** (Sirius), and 58 for Polaris

Star	GHA	SHA	Dec
18 Sirius	80° 46.2′	258° 25.1′	S 16° 44.9′
58 Polaris	135° 19.7′	312° 58.5′	N 89° 22.4′

Notes

- Accuracy 2025–2050: 57 stars $\leq 0.003'$; Polaris $\leq 0.04'$ in hour angle (tiny on the sky). Checked against USNO for 30 stars: $\leq 0.009'$.
- Star numbers are the official almanac numbers; the list in STAR_list.txt gives them by number and alphabetically.

SNAM — star names

Shows the name of a star from its number: key **18 XEQ SNAM** → display "18 Sirius". It stores the number in R49, jumps with GTO IND 49 to local label 01–58, loads the name as text and shows it with AVIEW. The stack is unchanged.

To show the name automatically after STAR, add RCL 82 · XEQ "SNAM" · R↓ before STAR's last RTN.

SUNRISE — rise, set, twilight, meridian passage

Times of sunrise, sunset, civil and nautical twilight and meridian passage for any position, directly in UT.

How it works

- Starts from a first guess (06h for morning events, 18h for evening, 12h for transit).
- Computes the Sun at that time with SUNF, a low-precision formula (Astronomical Almanac, within 0.01°; the tables when loaded), then the hour angle at which the Sun reaches the event altitude: $\cos H = (\sin h_0 - \sin \phi \sin \delta) / (\cos \phi \cos \delta)$.
- Corrects the time by (target LHA – actual LHA)/15 and repeats until the correction is under about 1 s (3–4 passes). With SUNF the times are within about 15 s of the full SUNA, well inside the minute shown.
- Event altitudes h_0 : rise/set $-0^\circ 50'$ (upper limb, refraction), civil -6° , nautical -12° . If the Sun never reaches it, the result is 99.

Inputs and outputs

Input	Z = JD at 0h UT of the day, Y = latitude (N+), X = longitude (E+, W–)
Labels	NTWA / CTWA (morning twilight), RISE, TRAN, SET, CTWP / NTWP (evening twilight)
Output	X = UT in decimal hours (→HMS to read); 99 = no event
Registers	R90-R99

Example with results

23 Sep 2026, latitude 10° N, longitude 0°: key **2461306.5 ENTER 10 ENTER 0**, then the label

Label	Event	UT	Almanac page (10° N)
NTWA	nautical twilight am	05:03:47	05 04
CTWA	civil twilight am	05:28:09	05 28
RISE	sunrise	05:49:09	05 49
TRAN	meridian passage	11:52:22	11 52 22
SET	sunset	17:55:28	17 56
CTWP	civil twilight pm	18:16:27	18 17
NTWP	nautical twilight pm	18:40:49	18 41

Medellín (6.25° N, 75.57° W): sunrise 10:51:24 UT (05:51 local), sunset 22:57:41 UT (17:57 local). 89.5° N: RISE gives 99 (no sunrise).

Notes

- Checked against an exact search on the JPL/IAU reference: agrees to the second.
- The almanac holds the noon declination fixed for the whole day, so its times can differ by up to a minute (sunset and civil pm above). The program is the more exact one.

PHAS — Moon phase

Percentage of the Moon's disk illuminated and the age of the Moon (days since new moon), as printed in the almanac.

How it works

- Runs SUNA, which leaves the mean Moon arguments D, M, M', F in R60–R63.
- Phase angle i (Meeus 48.4) $\rightarrow$ illuminated fraction $k = (1 + \cos i)/2$.
- Age: days since the mean new moon, corrected to the true new moon with Meeus ch. 49 terms; near new moon it checks the neighbouring lunation.

Inputs and outputs

Input	X = JD (UT1)
Output	X = % illuminated, Y = age (days)
Registers	R41–R48

Example with results

23 Sep 2026, 12:00 UT: key **2461307 XEQ PHAS** $\rightarrow$ X = **89.1 %** (waxing gibbous), Y = **12.36 days**. 10 Oct 2026 12h: 0.0 %, 29.36 d (new moon that evening); 11 Oct 12h: 0.8 %, 0.84 d.

Notes

- Accuracy vs JPL: illumination ≤ 0.3 %, age ≤ 2 minutes.

HORZ — sky picture on the horizon

Draws a chart of the whole sky: azimuth Z_n across (N–E–S–W–N, ticks every 30°), altitude H_c up (ticks and labels at 30° , 60° , 90°), the celestial equator dotted, and the same bodies as ALMF, HALMV and ALMT: the Sun ($\odot$), the Moon and planets above the horizon, and the brightest navigation stars higher than 10° until 10 bodies ($\star$ with its number). Then an info line for each body (name, Z_N , H_C), 3 s each, without end: after the last the first again. UT is at the top right, the DR under it; + returns to the NAV menu, the arrows move one hour. The Sun below the horizon is not drawn; its info line shows H_C with a minus sign.

How it works

- Runs SUNA once, then STAR through entry STR2 for stars 1–58 (fast: no repeated SUNA). The celestial equator is drawn as dots every 2° of hour angle.
- For each object: $LHA = GHA + \lambda$; $H_c = \text{asin}(\sin \varphi \sin \delta + \cos \varphi \cos \delta \cos LHA)$; Z_n from $\rightarrow$ POL of $(-\cos \delta \sin LHA, \cos \varphi \sin \delta - \sin \varphi \cos \delta \cos LHA)$.
- Screen: column = $20 + Z_n \times 375/360$; row = $225 - H_c \times 200/90$ (from the top; converted for the C47, which counts rows from the bottom). Only objects with $H_c > 0$ are drawn.
- Text (N E S W, 30 60 90, star numbers, the info line) is drawn with PTXT, the small AGRAPH font (PTNS for integers, PT1 for one decimal); the symbols with PTXS (* and @). Lines and dots use PHLS and PIXEL.

Inputs and outputs

Input	Z = JD (UT1), Y = latitude (N+), X = longitude (E+)
Output	drawing on the 400×240 screen; R96 = H_c and R97 = Z_n of the last object
Needs	SUNA, STAR (STR2), CHZ, PTXT, PTXS
Registers	R90–R99, R36, R37, R42, R44, R86, R93

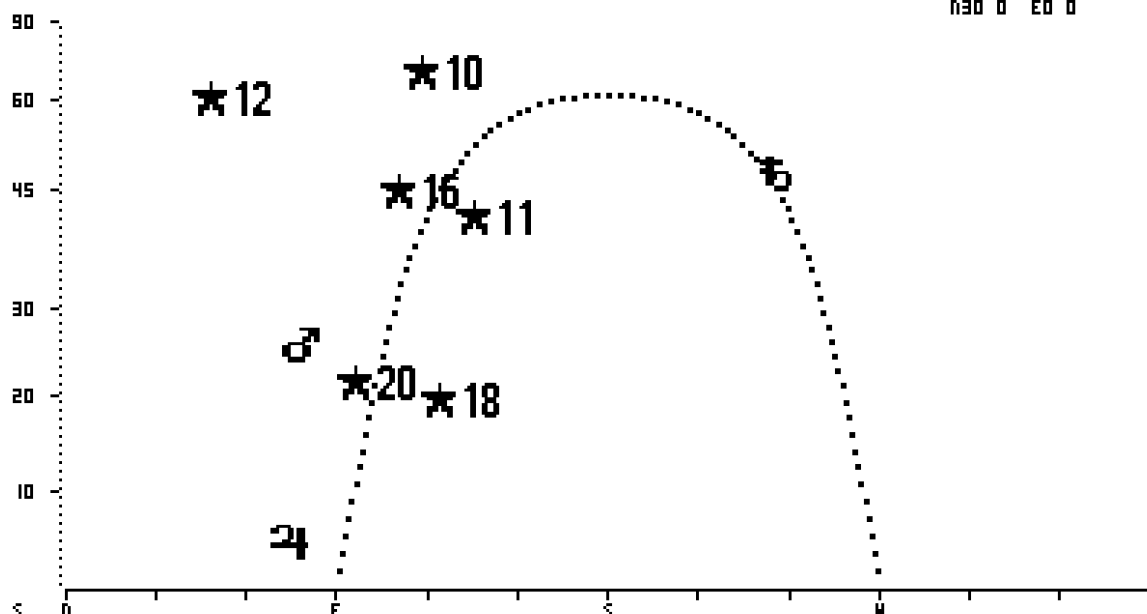
Example with results

23 Sep 2026, 30° N 0° E. Night 03:00 UT: key **2461306.625 ENTER 30 ENTER 0 XEQ HORZ**; day 09:00 UT: 2461306.875. Simulated screens:

SUN ZN 65.0 HC -36.3

03:00 UT

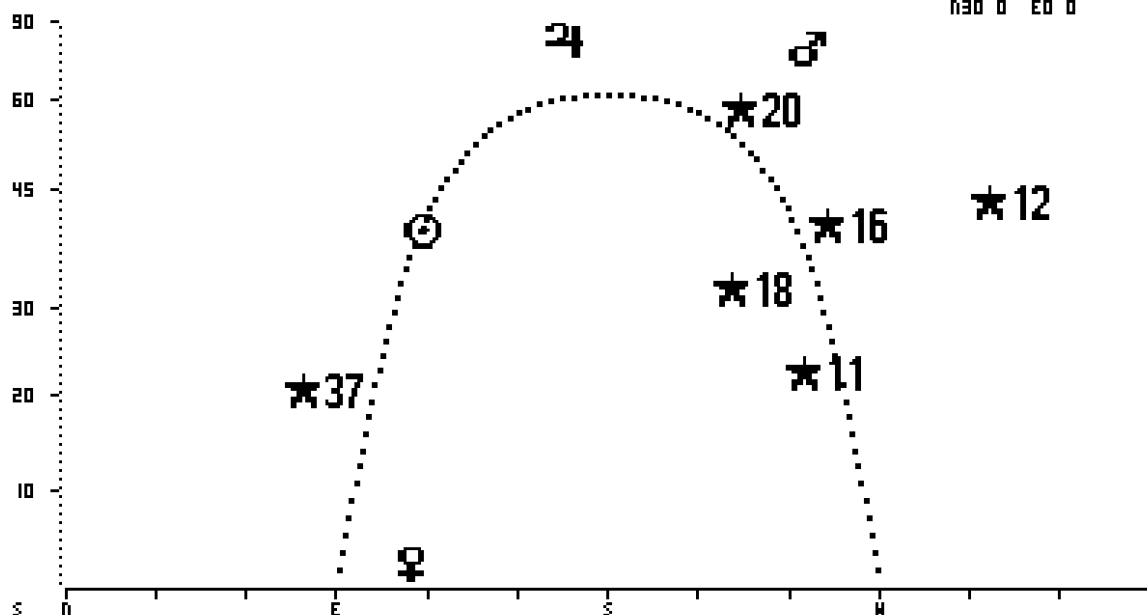
130 0 00 0



SUN ZN 118.3 HC 39.1

09:00 UT

130 0 00 0



Notes

- Hc and Zn agree with the reference within 0.0013'; Sun Hc/Zn match USNO (88.0833° / 264.215° vs 88.0834° / 264.214°).
- Stars are drawn even in daylight; they are only observable in twilight.

HALMV — sight-planning screen (chart + almanac data)

One screen for twilight star sights: on the left a picture of the sky (Hc up, Zn across) with the Sun, Moon, planets and the chosen stars; on the right the date and time, your DR, GHA Aries, the Sun's GHA, Dec and SD, a table of Hc and Zn (Sun, then the Moon and planets that are above the horizon, then the brightest stars, 10 rows), the day's sun times, and the Moon's phase, HP and SD.

How it works

- First computes the sun times with SUNRISE (NTWA, RISE, TRAN, SET, NTWP for the UT date of the JD) and the Moon with PHAS, and keeps them in R13-R19.

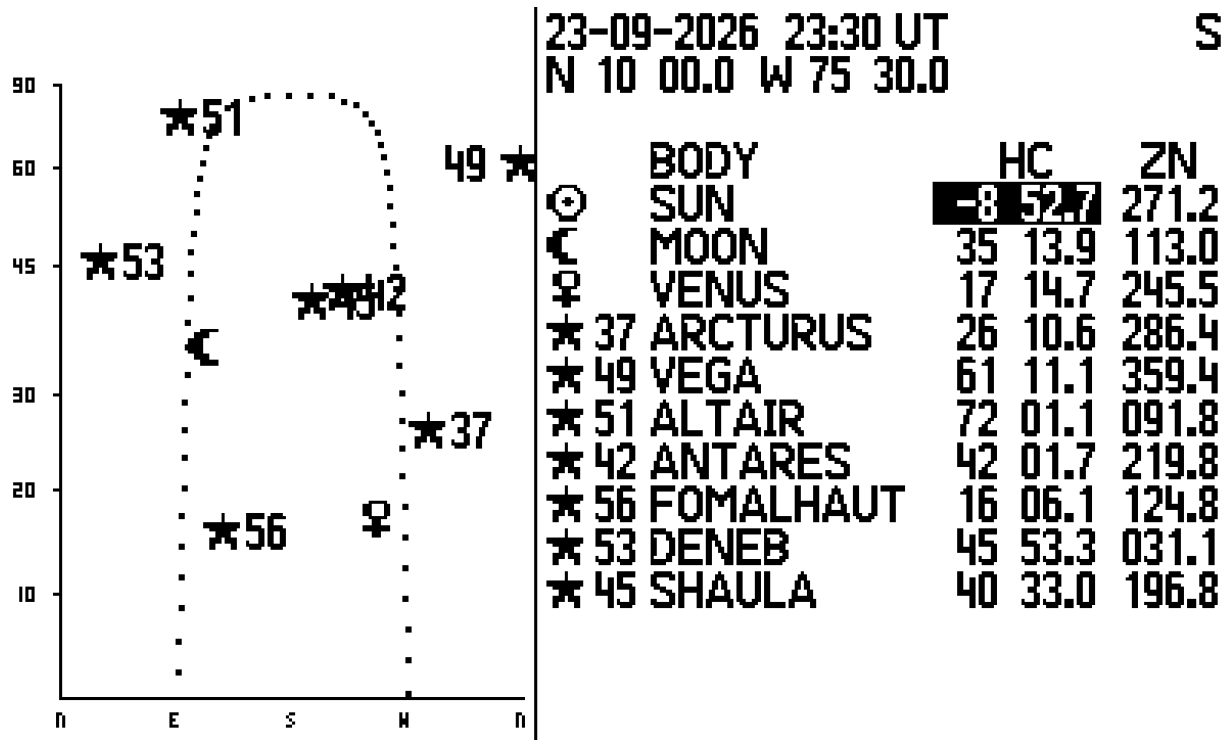
- Runs SUNA once (Sun GHA, Dec, GHA Aries; SD = 15.994' / R from R73), then STAR through entry STR2 for stars 1-58.
- Moon (MOO2) and planets (PLN3) are computed without repeating SUNA. PLN3 first places each planet from its mean orbit (within 0.2°); if it is more than 1° below the horizon the full series is skipped, otherwise the series run once with the light time from that first distance (same result as PLAN within 0.0002'). Symbols: ☾ Moon, ♀ Venus, ♂ Mars, ♃ Jupiter, ♄ Saturn. Stars: in order of brightness (SBRT), only those higher than 10°, until the table has 10 rows.
- Hc and Zn: CHZ subroutine HCZ. Chart: column = 18 + Zn × 178/360, row = 14 + Hc × 200/90; the celestial equator is dotted every 3° of hour angle. South latitude: chart centred on N (S W N E S).
- All text and numbers are drawn with AGRAPH through PTXS (the C47 status-bar font, 12 px) and PTXT (small 3×5): strings, PINS, PDMS (deg + min), PZNS (bearing), PHMS (hh:mm), PF1S and PDTS (date from JD). Star names from SNMU. The screen is held by WPLS (+ back to the menu, arrows one hour).

Inputs and outputs

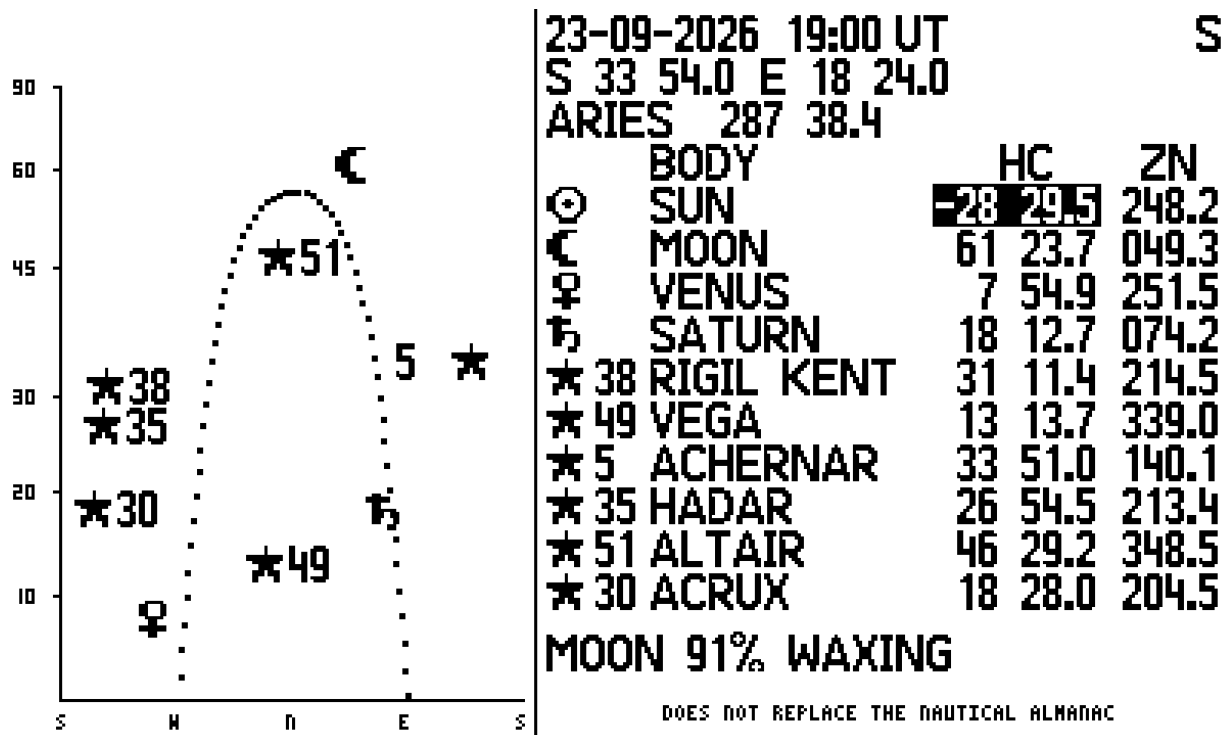
Input	Z = JD (UT1), Y = latitude (N+), X = longitude (E+)
Screen	left: chart; right: DR, date + UT, Aries, Sun SD, Sun GHA/Dec, table BODY / HC / ZN, naut. twilight AM/PM, rise/set, mer pass (UT), Moon % + WAXING/WANING/FULL/NEW + age
Needs	SUNA, STAR, CHZ, SUNRISE, PHAS, MOON, PLAN, SBRT, SNMU, PTXS + all matrices (MATA, MATST, MATM, MATP)
Registers	R10-R29, R37, R40-R48 (+ those of the programs it calls)

Example with results

23 Sep 2026, 23:30 UT, DR 10° 00' N 075° 30' W: key **2461307.4792 ENTER 10 ENTER -75.5 XEQ HALMV**. Simulated screen:



Southern example, 33° 54' S 018° 24' E, 19:00 UT (chart centred on N):



Notes

- Sun times checked against the JPL-based reference for this position: naut. twilight 10:05:46 / 23:42:41, rise 10:51:08, set 22:57:20, mer pass 16:54:18 UT — the screen rounds to the minute as the almanac does.
- All times are UT for the UT date of the JD, at the DR entered; sea level, standard refraction (as the almanac). West of Greenwich an evening event after 24h UT shows as 00:xx (next UT day).
- Hc and Zn are computed from the DR: use them to identify stars and pre-set the sextant. Near the chart edges two star numbers may overlap; the table is always exact.
- Sun SD = 959.63"/R; it can differ by 0.1' from the printed page, which gives one SD per three days.

ALMF — full-page almanac screen

The same data as HALMV without the chart, laid out like an almanac page: GHA and Dec as well as Hc and Zn, with the same 10-row rule as HALMV (Sun, then the Moon and planets above the horizon, then the brightest stars higher than 10°), the sun times, Moon phase, Moon HP and SD, and Sun SD. The last line reads DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC (also on HALMV).

How it works

- Same calculations and table rule as HALMV.
- Top line: date, UT, DR and GHA Aries. Table: symbol, number, name, GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn. Bottom left: nautical twilight and rise/set in AM/PM columns and meridian passage; bottom right: Moon % with WAXING, WANING, FULL (shown 100 %) or NEW (0 %), age, Sun SD.

Inputs and outputs

Input	Z = JD (UT1), Y = latitude (N+), X = longitude (E+)
Needs	same programs as HALMV
Registers	same as HALMV

Example with results

Same instant and DR as the HALMV example: key **2461307.4792 ENTER 10 ENTER -75.5 XEQ ALMF**. Simulated screen:

23-09-2026 23:30 UT DR N 10 00.0 W 75 30.0										S
	BODY	GHA		DEC		HC		ZN		
	ARIES	355	19.5							
☉	SUN	174	26.9	S	0	22.8	-8 52.7		271.2	
☾	MOON	25	09.3	S	12	19.9	35 13.9		113.0	
♀	VENUS	142	57.4	S	19	47.4	17 14.7		245.5	
★ 37	ARCTURUS	141	06.4	N	19	02.7	26 10.6		286.4	
★ 49	VEGA	75	51.7	N	38	48.8	61 11.1		359.4	
★ 51	ALTAIR	57	17.9	N	8	56.5	72 01.1		091.8	
★ 42	ANTARES	107	33.7	S	26	29.5	42 01.7		219.8	
★ 56	FOMALHAUT	10	32.1	S	29	28.7	16 06.1		124.8	
★ 53	DENEK	44	44.1	N	45	22.8	45 53.3		031.1	
NAUT TWI 10:06 23:43					MOON 92% WAXING					
RISE/SET 10:51 22:57					AGE 12.8 DAYS					
MER PASS 16:54 SD 15.9					HP 56.0 SD 15.3					

Notes

- GHA and Dec are the almanac values for that instant (Sun $\leq 0.02'$, stars $\leq 0.003'$ against JPL); read them directly for sight reduction.
- HALM is a third layout of the same data: chart on the top half, table (GHA, Dec, Hc, Zn) on the bottom half.

Supporting programs for the screens

Program	Use	Stack
PTXS	the C47 status-bar font (12 px); * = star, @ = sun, also % ; entries PINS, PDMS, PZNS, PHMS, PF1S, PDTS	Z = y, Y = x, X = text or number $\rightarrow Y = y$, X = next x
PTXT	small 3x5 pixel font, same characters and stack	as PTXS
SNMU	star name in capitals, returned in X (no display)	X = star no. $\rightarrow$ X = name
SUNSD	Sun semi-diameter 15.994' / R	X = JD $\rightarrow$ X = SD (')
CHZ / HCZ / DHA	Hc and Zn; inverse gives Dec, LHA, GHA	CHZ: T lat, Z lon, Y Dec, X GHA $\rightarrow$ X Hc, Y Zn

ALM — table method (Sun, Aries, Moon, planets)

Evaluates short Chebyshev polynomials whose coefficients you key in from the tables in C47_GHA_Dec_Almanac.pdf or the Excel file. It is the program for the Moon and the planets (Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn).

How it works

- Each table line covers a block: 8 days (192 h) for Sun, Aries and planets; 1 day (24 h) for the Moon.
- $x = 2t/\text{span} - 1$, where t = hours since the start of the block.
- CHEB sums the series with the Clenshaw recurrence; ALM does it for GHA (R10...) and Dec (R20...); HP does the Moon's horizontal parallax (R30-R33).

Inputs and outputs

Store	R01 = n (5, Moon 6), R02 = span (192, Moon 24), GHA coefficients R10..., Dec R20..., Moon HP R30-R33
Input	X = t (hours since the block start, UT1)
Output	X = GHA, Y = Dec; XEQ HP $\rightarrow$ horizontal parallax (arcmin)

Store	R01 = n (5, Moon 6), R02 = span (192, Moon 24), GHA coefficients R10..., Dec R20..., Moon HP R30-R33
Registers	R01-R09, R10-R33, R40-R41

Example with results

Sun, 23 Sep 2026 12:00 UT: block 2026-09-17, $t = 6 \times 24 + 12 = 156$

	c0	c1	c2	c3	c4
GHA	1621.68475	1440.35480	-0.00108	-0.00024	-0.00000
Dec	0.77751	-1.55320	-0.00149	0.00024	-0.00000

Result: GHA 1° 54.4', Dec S 0° 11.6' (same as SUNA).

Moon, 23 Sep 2026 19:00 UT: block 2026-09-23, $t = 19$

	c0	c1	c2	c3	c4	c5
GHA	217.86332	174.54982	0.01758	-0.00081	-0.00002	0.00000
Dec	-14.82363	2.56120	0.04565	-0.00100	-0.00001	-0.00000
HP	55.738	0.303	0.004	-0.000		

Result: GHA 319° 40.8', Dec S 13° 20.6', HP 55.91' ($SD \approx 0.2725 \times HP = 15.24'$).

Notes

- Accuracy 0.002' (HP 0.001'). Tables valid 1 Sep 2026 – 31 Dec 2027; later years with `c47_almanac_generator.py`.
- Not yet run on the C47: check RCL IND and DSE with the Sun example.

TBL and TGET — almanac tables, and the T / S switch

Precise GHA and Dec for a limited period, taken from Chebyshev tables fitted to the JPL ephemeris (the same source as the printed almanac). Once the tables are loaded, the Sun, Aries, Moon and planets on every screen come from them automatically, the screens need about half the program steps, and each screen shows **T** (tables) or **S** (series). Outside the table period everything falls back to the series (SUNA, MOON, PLAN), which work for any date.

How it works

- **Making the tables (PC):** `tools/almanac/c47_almanac_generator.py` computes apparent GHA and Dec from JPL DE421 with the IAU 2006/2000A precession-nutation (ERFA) and fits a Chebyshev polynomial to each block: 8 days (5 terms) for the Sun, Aries and planets, 1 day (6 terms, plus 4 for HP) for the Moon. The tables for 1 Sep 2026 – 31 Dec 2027 are in the Excel file.
- **Turning them into a C47 program:** `tools/almanac/tab2c47.py` START END writes TBL.txt (convert with `rejig`). TBL builds one matrix per body — TSU Sun, TVE Venus, TMA Mars, TJU Jupiter, TSA Saturn, TMO Moon, TAR Aries — and sets flag 10. Row 1 of each matrix holds the JD of the first block, the block length in days, the number of blocks and the number of terms; each following row holds the coefficients of one block.
- **TGET** finds the block for the JD, computes $x = 2 (JD - \text{block start}) / \text{length} - 1$ and sums the series (Clenshaw) for GHA (MOD 360), Dec and, for the Moon, HP; $SD = 358473400 \sin HP / 6378.14 / 60$.
- **The switch (flag 10 set):** SUNA replaces the Sun GHA/Dec (R81, R77) and GHA Aries (R80) with the table values; the stars keep their own calculation with that GHA Aries. SUNG, used by the SUNRISE iterations, takes the Sun from the tables (outside them, the low-precision SUNF). MOO2 and PLN2 call TGET first; if the date is outside the table they compute the series. MOO2 sets flag 11 when the Moon came from the tables.
- **The letter on the screens:** T = flag 11 (the Moon, and so everything except the stars, from the tables), S = series. ALMF and HALMV bottom right, HORZ and HORZS bottom left, ALMT at the end of the first line. On days at the edge of the period (the Moon table starts or ends one day before the 8-day blocks) the screen shows S while the Sun and planets may already come from the tables.

Inputs and outputs

TBL run once: XEQ TBL → builds the matrices, sets flag 10, shows “TBL 26-09-2026 TO 31-01-2027”. The TBL program can then be deleted; the matrices stay.

TGET in	Y = JD (UT1), X = body: 0 Sun, 1 Venus, 2 Mars, 3 Jupiter, 4 Saturn, 5 Moon, 6 Aries
TGET out	X = GHA, Y = Dec (degrees); Moon also Z = HP, T = SD (arcmin); Aries Y = 0. X = -1 when the date is outside the table.
Flags	10 = tables loaded (CF 10 = use the series only); 11 = Moon from the tables (T on the screens)
Registers	TGET: R00-R09, R35-R39 (the MOON/PLAN work registers)
Programs	TBL, TGET and the updated SUNA, SUNRISE, MOON, PLAN, ALMF, HALMV, HORZ, HORZS, ALMT

Example with results

Cape Town (33° 54' S, 18° 24' E), 23 Nov 2026 09:00 UT, JD 2461367.875. Tables (TGET) against the series programs:

Body	GHA tables	Dec tables	GHA series	Dec series	ΔGHA	ΔDec
Sun	318° 24.7'	S 20° 22.4'	318° 24.7'	S 20° 22.4'	0.002'	0.004'
Moon	157° 34.8'	N 20° 40.0'	157° 34.8'	N 20° 40.0'	0.006'	0.016'
Venus	354° 32.5'	S 9° 15.4'	354° 32.4'	S 9° 15.4'	0.023'	0.018'

Moon HP 60.10' and SD 16.38' from the tables (series 60.10', 16.38'). GHA Aries 197° 21.2'. Outside the table (1 Mar 2027) TGET returns -1 for the Moon.

Program steps for the same screens, series → tables:

Screen	Series	Tables	Saving
ALMF	100,142	38,490	62 %
HALMV	109,732	48,080	56 %
HORZS	67,201	27,990	58 %

ALMF with the tables — note the T in the bottom right corner:

23-11-2026 09:00 UT DR S 33 54.0 E 18 24.0						T
	BODY	GHA	DEC	HC	ZN	
	ARIES	197 21.2				
☉	SUN	318 24.7 S 20 22.4		65 25.4	062.6	
♀	VENUS	354 32.5 S 9 15.4		62 38.2	331.3	
♂	MARS	45 31.2 N 13 49.3		12 46.3	296.6	
♃	JUPITER	48 26.8 N 13 26.5		10 49.4	294.4	
★ 17	CANOPUS	101 12.5 S 52 42.4		11 15.5	212.5	
★ 38	RIGIL KENT	337 00.0 S 60 56.7		62 47.5	175.1	
★ 37	ARCTURUS	343 08.0 N 19 02.5		37 02.3	358.2	
★ 35	HADAR	345 55.6 S 60 30.0		63 15.1	184.7	
★ 30	ACRUX	10 20.0 S 63 14.7		55 39.5	202.6	
NAUT TWI 02:28 18:38 MOON 98% WAXING						
RISE/SET 03:31 17:35 AGE 14.1 DAYS						
MER PASS 10:33 SD 16.2 HP 60.1 SD 16.4						

DOES NOT REPLACE THE NAUTICAL ALMANAC

Notes

- Differences between tables and series are the series' own error: at most about 0.005' for the Sun, 0.02' for the planets and 0.07' for the Moon. On the screens this changes at most the last digit (0.1').
- One TGET call takes about 265 steps (Moon 400) against 2 000–12 000 for the series; that is where the time saving comes from.
- The tables expire: load the next period in time (a quarter or a year per file, depending on memory). TBL for 26 Sep 2026 – 31 Jan 2027 holds 3 054 numbers, about the size of MATP.
- ΔT (TT – UT1) is fixed in the generator (69.2 s). One second of error moves the Moon by about 0.01'.

- The PC version (python/native/c47pc.py) reads the same tables (by default build/TBL_5.txt, 1 Oct 2026 – 30 Sep 2031) and gives the same screens (box “Almanac tables”, or --tables / --series).

Using the results for Hc and Zn

- GHA and Dec at the sight time (UT = UTC + DUT1): SUNA (Sun), STAR (stars), ALM (Moon, planets).
- $LHA = GHA + \lambda (E +), \text{ mod } 360$.
- $Hc = \text{asin}(\sin \varphi \sin \delta + \cos \varphi \cos \delta \cos LHA)$.
- $Zn = \text{atan2}(-\cos \delta \sin LHA, \cos \varphi \sin \delta - \sin \varphi \cos \delta \cos LHA), \text{ mod } 360$.
- Intercept = Ho – Hc, toward Zn if positive. The C47 key →HcZ may do these steps directly.
- For Ho you still need index error, dip, refraction, SD (☉ from R73, ☾ from ALM HP) and the almanac's planet corrections.

Python and NumWorks version

nav.py + navdata.py contain the same methods (SUNA, STAR, SUNRISE, PHAS) for a computer or a NumWorks. The menu asks for year, month, day and UT (hh:mm:ss) and computes the JD itself. Results are identical to the C47 programs (for example Sun 23 Sep 2026 12h: GHA 1° 54.4′, Dec S 0° 11.6′).

PC version (c47pc 1.5)

python/native/c47pc.py shows the same screens in a window on the PC (GTK 3), with its own calculations and no calculator programs, identical pixel for pixel to the C47. – / + step the UT (keys or the buttons next to Now UTC) by 1 s to 999 days (1 h by default); hold the key to watch the sky move. It also writes a screen to PNG (--png) or the ALMT lines as text.

Register map

Program	Registers
SUNA	50–55, 60–67, 70–81
STAR	56–59, 68–69, 82–89
SUNRISE, HORZ	90–99
PHAS	41–48
SNAM	49
ALM	01–09, 10–33, 40–41
CHZ	91–92, 94–97
PTXS / PTXT	30–36
HALMV, ALMF, HALM	10–29, 37, 40–48 (work registers, results of SUNRISE/PHAS kept in 13–19)

C47 notes

- The C47 does not treat →DEG and flag 77 like the HP-42S; the programs avoid both (verified on the C47 with SUNA).
- Memory: NAVFULL about 13 000 steps; the FULL matrices about 6 000 numbers (FAST about 3 400), plus the cache matrices ALMC (73 × 4) and ALMQ (300 × 3).
- Keep the printed Nautical Almanac as the primary reference; use the calculator as support and cross-check.